Local-First Dubbing Workflow Checklist

A stage-by-stage checklist for shipping AI-dubbed video without giving up control. Use it to audit an existing pipeline or spec a new one. Print it, share it, adapt it — attribution appreciated.

1. Ingest & project setup

- ■ Source media stored on a local disk you control (not a synced cloud folder).
- ■ Working project folder is excluded from cloud backup services that scan file contents.
- ■ Source clip demuxed; original picture stream preserved untouched.
- ■ Audio normalized to a single sample rate before ASR.
- ■ Project has a target language, target loudness, and delivery spec written down.

2. Transcription (ASR)

- ■ ASR runs locally (DirectML / TensorRT RTX / CPU fallback), not against a remote API.
- ■ Transcript is editable per line, with timestamps preserved.
- ■ Names, jargon, and product terms reviewed and corrected before translation.
- ■ Overlapping speech flagged for manual cleanup.

3. Translation

- ■ Translation is editable line-by-line without re-running ASR.
- ■ Register, formality, and idioms reviewed against target-market norms.
- ■ On-screen text and burned-in captions handled separately from dialogue.
- ■ Glossary of protected terms (brands, product names) applied consistently.

4. Diarization & speaker mapping

- ■ Each speaker has a stable ID across the whole project.
- ■ Reassigning a speaker on one line doesn't invalidate other stages.
- ■ Voice prints stored locally, never uploaded without explicit opt-in.

5. Voice generation (TTS)

- ■ TTS runs locally with acceleration appropriate to the machine.
- ■ Per-line regeneration is possible without rerunning the pipeline.

- Timing budget per line respects the shot; overruns flagged, not silently trimmed.
- Prosody / pacing controls exposed for problem lines.

6. Mix & preview

- Original music and effects preserved; only dialogue is ducked/replaced.
- Optional stem separation available for tricky source mixes.
- Preview render is fast enough to iterate — not a queued cloud job.
- Final mix meets the delivery loudness spec (e.g. -23 LUFS EBU R128, -16 LUFS streaming).

7. Reliability & recovery

- Jobs are resumable after crash, cancel, OOM, or power loss.
- Failure classes are typed (download, lock, OOM, cancel) — not string-matched.
- Errors name the stage AND the cause; no generic "failed".
- Completed stages are not silently re-run when one line changes.

8. Privacy & sovereignty

- Media, transcripts, and voice prints stay on the workstation by default.
- Any cloud stage is opt-in per project AND per stage — never implicit.
- NDA / client footage never leaves the machine without written approval.
- Model artifacts are checksum-verified before load.